UNIT - 4

Social Media and Customer Engagement

What is meant by the Social Feedback Cycle?

The Social Feedback Cycle refers to the process where customer experiences are shared publicly through social media, influencing other consumers′ purchase decisions. It connects marketing, customer service, and social engagement by turning customer feedback into marketing content.

Compare traditional marketing and social engagement marketing.

Aspect	Traditional Marketing	Social Engagement Marketing
Communication	One-way (brand to consumer)	Two-way (brand and consumer interact)
Medium	TV, radio, print, billboards	Social media platforms, blogs, communities
Customer Role	Passive receiver	Active participant
Feedback	Slow or indirect	Instant and public
Reach	Local or regional	Global

List the advantages of integrating CRM with social media.

- Improves customer engagement and relationship management.
- Provides real-time insights into customer preferences and behavior.
- Enhances customer service through faster responses.
- Strengthens brand loyalty and trust.
- Enables personalized marketing and better lead generation.

Identify the elements of a Social Business Ecosystem.

- **People:** Employees, customers, influencers, and communities.
- **Processes:** Communication, collaboration, and workflow systems.
- **Platforms:** Social media, CRM tools, and collaboration apps.
- **Content:** Shared posts, blogs, videos, and discussions.
- **Governance:** Policies, ethics, and security measures.

What is meant by Blogger Outreach?

Blogger Outreach is a digital marketing strategy where brands collaborate with influential bloggers to promote their products or services to a wider audience through blog posts, reviews, or social media mentions.

Discuss the role of The Social Web in creating engagement. Give examples of platforms and techniques. (Based on Flipkart)

The **Social Web** has played a major role in helping **Flipkart**, one of India's largest e-commerce platforms, create deep customer engagement and brand loyalty.

Role of the Social Web in Flipkart's Engagement:

1. **Customer Interaction and Feedback:**
   Flipkart uses platforms like **Twitter, Facebook, and Instagram** to interact directly with customers. Customers share product reviews, complaints, and compliments, and Flipkart responds promptly – turning feedback into improvement opportunities.
2. **Brand Awareness and Community Building:**
   Through social campaigns like **#BigBillionDays** and **#FlipkartSmartBuy**, Flipkart creates large-scale buzz and encourages customers to share posts and deals, thereby building a loyal online community.
3. **User-Generated Content (UGC):**
   Flipkart motivates users to share their shopping experiences, product unboxing, and feedback videos. These genuine posts enhance trust among new customers.
4. **Personalized Recommendations:**
   Using data from customer interactions on the social web, Flipkart provides tailored offers and personalized advertisements on social media, improving engagement and conversion rates.
5. **Customer Service through Social Media:**
   Flipkart's support team uses **Twitter handles (@FlipkartSupport)** and **Facebook chat** to provide real-time assistance, building trust and satisfaction.

Examples of Platforms and Techniques Used by Flipkart:

Platform	**Technique Used**	**Purpose**
Facebook & Instagram	Interactive posts, contests, polls, and reels	Encourage customer participation and sharing
Twitter (X)	Quick responses to customer issues and real-time campaign updates	Strengthen brand reliability

YouTube	Product demo videos, influencer collaborations	Educate customers and boost brand visibility
LinkedIn	Employer branding and thought leadership posts	Strengthen Flipkart's corporate image
Influencer Marketing	Collaboration with tech, lifestyle, and fashion influencers	Reach niche audiences with authentic reviews

Outcome:

The social web enables Flipkart to maintain continuous engagement, gather insights, and convert online conversations into brand trust and sales.

Describe the process and benefits of Blogger Outreach in digital marketing. (Based on Flipkart)

Blogger Outreach is a key part of Flipkart's **digital marketing strategy**, used to expand reach, build credibility, and promote new products through trusted voices in the blogging and influencer community.

Process of Blogger Outreach at Flipkart:

1. **Identifying Relevant Bloggers and Influencers:**
   Flipkart identifies influential bloggers and vloggers in categories such as **fashion, electronics, gadgets, books, and lifestyle** who align with its target audience.
2. **Building Relationships:**
   Flipkart connects with bloggers through social platforms, influencer networks, and PR teams. They offer exclusive access to new products or events (like *Flipkart Big Billion Days previews*).
3. **Collaboration and Campaign Design:**
   Bloggers are invited to create **product reviews, tutorials, unboxing videos, and sponsored blog posts**. Flipkart often provides discount codes or referral links for tracking performance.
4. **Content Creation and Promotion:**
   Bloggers publish authentic and creative content about Flipkart's offerings on their blogs, YouTube channels, or Instagram handles. Flipkart amplifies these posts through its official pages and paid campaigns.

5. **Tracking and Performance Measurement:**
   Flipkart analyzes engagement metrics such as clicks, impressions, mentions, conversions, and sentiment analysis to measure campaign success.

Benefits of Blogger Outreach for Flipkart:

1. **Enhanced Brand Credibility:**
   Recommendations from trusted bloggers and influencers make customers more likely to trust Flipkart's products and offers.
2. **Targeted Audience Reach:**
   Bloggers help Flipkart reach niche groups – for example, tech bloggers reach gadget lovers, while fashion bloggers target style-conscious customers.
3. **Improved SEO and Online Visibility:**
   Backlinks from popular blogs improve Flipkart's search engine ranking and visibility.
4. **Authentic Word-of-Mouth Promotion:**
   Blogger opinions feel personal and relatable, which influences purchase decisions more effectively than traditional ads.
5. **Increased Sales and Conversions:**
   Product reviews and tutorials drive traffic to Flipkart's site, especially during major campaigns like *The Big Billion Days* or *End of Season Sales.*
6. **Long-Term Partnerships:**
   Continuous collaboration with bloggers builds lasting relationships and consistent brand presence.

Example:

During **Flipkart's Big Billion Days**, the company collaborates with tech YouTubers (like gadget reviewers) and lifestyle bloggers who create content showcasing deals, product features, and shopping tips. Their followers then visit Flipkart, significantly increasing traffic and sales.